

SEMINAR 2

History of AI

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Outline of this seminar

- Reading; recap and reconstruction:
 - Chapter 4 – Inventing the computer
 - Chapter 5 – Computer as a business machine
 - Break
 - Writing; Essay structure
 - Writing; Work on assignment 2
- At the end of this session, you've recapped chapter 4 and 5 and completed assignment 2!

Chapter 4 – Inventing the computer

- What was this chapter about? What was the main narrative line, when and where did it start and conclude?

Chapter 4 – Inventing the computer

- Which people, organizations, institutions... played a role in the narrative of this chapter?

Chapter 4 – Inventing the computer

- Which people, organizations, institutions... played a role in the narrative of this chapter?
 - OSRD/NDRC (Bush), Moore School (Mauchly), BRL
 - Mauchly + Eckert (MTI) → (+Goldstine) → ENIAC
 - ... + Von Neumann → EDVAC → First Draft..., Moore School Lectures, EMCC
 - Moore School Lectures: Newman, Williams → Manchester Baby; Wilkes → EDSAC
 - *Atanasoff* → *ABC*

Chapter 5 – The Computer Becomes a Business Machine

- What is the main thesis of the chapter?
- What does the chapter talk about? What are the main narrative lines?

Chapter 5 – The Computer Becomes a Business Machine

- What does the chapter talk about? What are the main narrative lines?
 - 3 kinds of computer companies: Electronics (RCA, GE, Honeywell...), Business Machines (IBM, Remington Rand, NCR, Burroughs...), Startups (EMCC, ERA)
 - Eckert and Mauchly → UNIVAC (Census Bureau), BINAC (Northrop); founding problems. Then acquired by Remington Rand, 1952 election prediction.
 - IBM – slow approach to computers after Harvard Mk 1. scandal; Watson laboratory (SSEC) → technical background, PR success; Slow evolution → series of calculators, slowly introducing electronics into existing products; MDC and TPM → delayed due to Defense Calculator
 - IBM vs UNIVAC → Model 650 (MDC) dominates the market, UNIVAC falls behind in popularity due to IBM marketing and infrastructure. By the end of the 50s: “IBM and 7 dwarfs” (but still mainly a punch-card company at this time!)

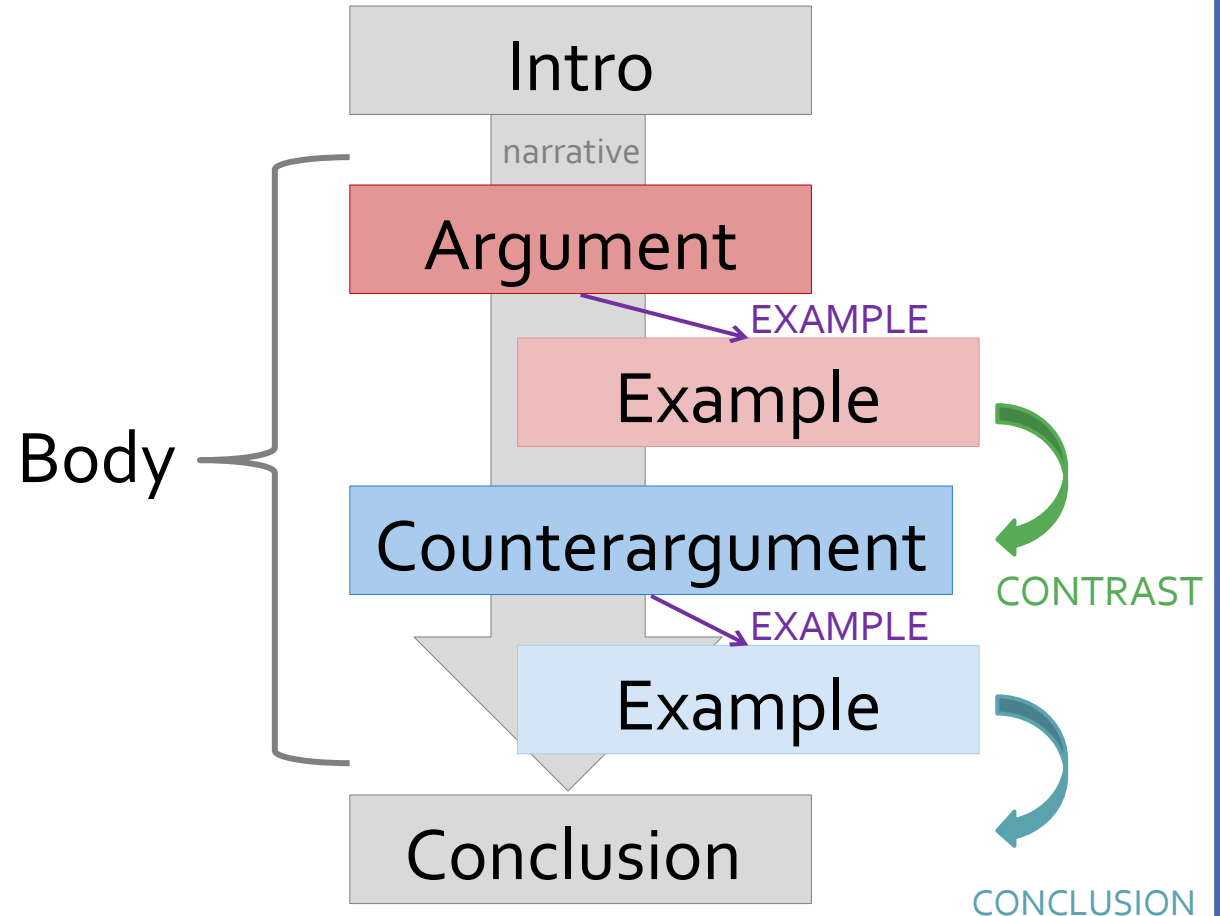
BREAK

Essay structure: outline of an essay

- What is an essay?
 - Statement (thesis)/question → narrative (here, the “thesis” is defined by the exam question)
 - Structure: intro, body, conclusion
- 
- Intro
 - Tell what the reader can expect in the following text
 - Perhaps one sentence summarizing your content
 - Advanced: a question, anecdote or statistic
 - Body
 - The actual content
 - Conclusion
 - Summary, repeating of the question/statement if present
 - Advanced: follow-up question

Building an essay structure

1. Define your content (notes) → thesis
2. Design your structure
3. “Fill in” the structure
4. Check your work
 - a. Did you answer all the questions?
 - b. Does your answer make sense?
 - c. Do you have an intro, a body and a conclusion?
 - d. Did you use the appropriate signal words?
 - e. Does the narrative make sense?



Essay structure: signal words

- How to find a fitting narrative?
 - Work towards your thesis
 - Use signal words – they are “labels” so that the reader knows what to expect next

I love tiramisu **because** it's creamy, sweet, **and** a little bitter. I like panna cotta, **too**, **but** tiramisu is creamier. **For example**, I could eat two servings without regret. **In the end**, tiramisu is my favorite dessert

- Final tip: reading out loud

ADDITION

A and B

and
firstly, secondly...
additionally
also

COMPARISON

A resembles B

similarly
likewise
in the same way
too

CONTRAST

A contradicts B

but
On one hand, on other hand...
however
in contrast

EXAMPLE

A illustrates B

for example
for instance
such as
also

CAUSAL

A causes B

because
so
since
thus

CONCLUSION

of thesis

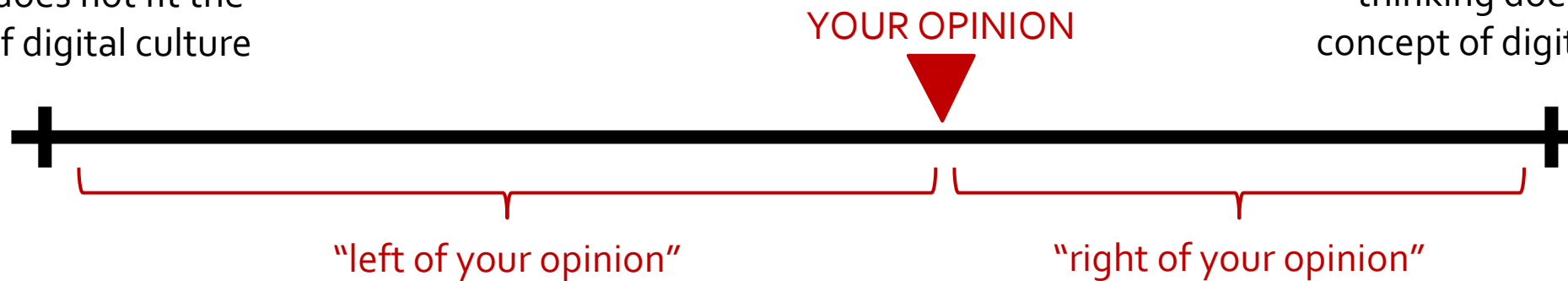
in the end
ultimately
in conclusion
to sum up

“To what extent”

To what extent does the concept of systems thinking fit the concept of digital culture?

The concept of systems thinking does not fit the concept of digital culture

The concept of systems thinking does fit the concept of digital culture



- Explain your “point on the line,” so the part left of it and the part right of it

Assignment 2.2 Moore school

In what ways was Moore school relevant in the history of computing?
Distinguish between the pre-war, war and post-war period.

- a) Refine the structure of your answer. Is it clear where the intro starts, where the body starts and where the conclusion starts?
- b) Did you answer all parts of the question?
- c) Exchange with neighbor for feedback.

Assignment 2.4 Alan Turing

To what extent can Alan Turing be regarded as the father of AI?

- a) Refine the structure of your answer. Is it clear where the intro starts, where the body starts and where the conclusion starts?
- b) Did you answer the question fully?
- c) Exchange with neighbor for feedback.

QUESTIONS?

See you next week!